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HEADQUARTERS
PHILIPPINES-RYUKYUS COMMAND
Office of the AC of S for Int, G-2

APO 707
12 March 1947

GSB

SUBJECT: Conditions in Formosa

TO : Assistant Chief of Staff, G-2, GHQ, FAR EAST COMMAND
APO 500

Forwarded herewith are three copies of Intelligence Reports No 39, dated 6 March 1947, subject: "Conditions in Formosa."

D.G. McLENNAN
Lt Colonel, GSC
AC of S for Int, G-2

Incls: a/s

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HEADQUARTERS
PHILIPPINES-RYUKYUS COMMAND
Office of the AC of S for Int, G-2

APO 707
6 March 1947

INTELLIGENCE REPORT NO 39

SUBJECT: Conditions in Formosa

SUMMARY: Formosa is not under the civil and military jurisdiction of this headquarters, but agents from this command secured information, incidental to a survey of another area, of sufficient interest to warrant a report.

This report deals with civil, economic and social conditions in Formosa and the status of the Chinese Army stationed there. Since the Chinese occupation, conditions in the island have been steadily deteriorating. At the present time Formosans find it impossible to maintain an acceptable standard of living; and, because of Chinese domination, they do not enjoy civil rights and liberties comparable to people of other occupied areas.

The information in this report was secured from two citizens of Miyako Retto, Mr. Keitatsu Sunakawa and Mr. Kanto Ishihana, by agents of 1135th CIC Detachment, Ryukyus Field Office. Information checked and edited by Intelligence Division, G-2, PHILRYCOM. Evaluation: B-3.

D. G. McLENNAN
Lt Col, GSC
AC of S for Int, G-2

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CONDITIONS IN FORMOSA

G-2, PHILRYCOM
Intelligence Report No 39

1. Political:

The Formosan government is completely under the control of the Chinese Occupation forces. It is headed by Chingi, a Chinese Nationalist, who has established, under the central government, nine city and seven prefectural governments. All governmental agencies are under the jurisdiction of the Chinese Army and Navy.

Chinese, including some Chinese communists, constitute approximately ten per cent of the Formosan population. Pro-communist literature has been distributed through the island. The propaganda follows the line that the communists are winning the war in China and promises improved living standards in Formosa under a communist regime. The identity and strength of active communists is unknown, since they must operate underground. The Chinese Army has succeeded in arresting some of them.

2. Police:

The Chinese-controlled police department is composed of about one-half Chinese military personnel and one-half Formosan civilians. Apparently no attempt is made to enforce civil law or defend civil rights. Informants state that when a complaint is made to the police department the complainant is frequently thrown into jail and the complaint seldom investigated.

3. Chinese Army:

In December 1945 the strength of the Chinese Army was estimated at 20,000. By October 1946 it had been reduced to about 5,000. The Army is poorly equipped and badly supplied. When the Chinese arrived the Formosans welcomed them, but since that time considerable friction has developed, principally because of unwarranted harsh treatment of civilians and appropriation of food by the Chinese.

4. Economic:

The standard of living in Formosa is extremely low. Most of the people suffer from malnutrition and, as a result, disease is rampant. The Chinese import no food to alleviate the situation; instead they supply themselves from the meager Formosan stocks of food. Living conditions during the war were better for 90 per cent of the people because at that time prices were lower and food was rationed. At present, incomes are low and prices are very high. The average monthly salary is about 3,000 yen. Unemployment is widespread because of the collapse of commerce and industry after the war.

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The following is a list of prices of basic foods in Formosa:

Rice, per pound	18 yen
Fish, " "	70 yen
Pork, " "	90 yen
Beef, " "	80 yen
Sugar, " "	55 yen
Tea, " "	50 to 100 yen

5. Schools:

Prior to the Chinese occupation, 90 per cent of the Formosan children were attending school. Because of economic pressure many children have been forced to quit school in order to aid their families. As a result, the present enrollment has dropped to approximately fifty per cent of school-age children. The only direct Chinese influence in the schools has been the introduction of the Chinese language as a cultural course; in other respects the curriculum remains unchanged.

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